

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete King's Indian Defense

Black-side structures, theory, counterplay, and attacking decisions

COURSE BOOK

30 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

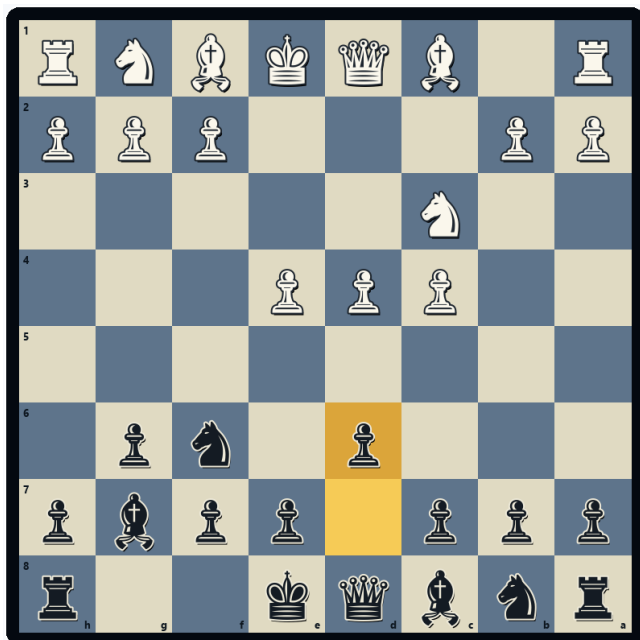
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
KID FOUNDATION	2
KID CLASSICAL	6
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KID WHITE SYSTEMS	12
KID STRUCTURES	4
KID MOVE ORDERS	4

01. King's Indian Core Setup - Stage 1



KID FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

Black has invited a broad white center while developing efficiently.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, castle, then strike with ...e5 or ...c5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to stabilize the center and use the extra space to restrict Black.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6

MEMORY RULE

The shell is preparation; the central break is the opening's real point.

01. Decision Framework

King's Indian Core Setup - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Choose ...e5 for direct central contact or ...c5 to attack d4 from the flank.
PIECE JOB	The g7-bishop and f6-knight pressure the center before it opens.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not drift after castling; an unchallenged center will become a lasting space advantage.
TRADE FILTER	Trade only when the resulting structure gives Black active files or clear central targets.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use normal opening speed until White creates contact, a capture, or a concrete threat.

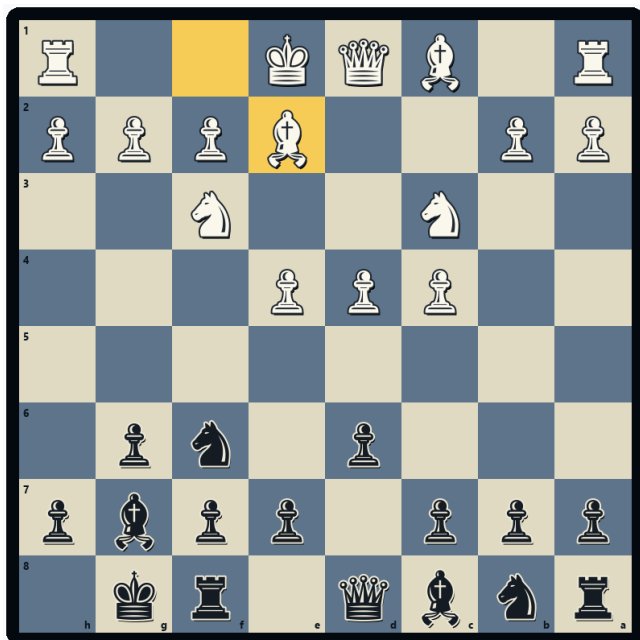
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The shell is preparation; the central break is the opening's real point.

02. King's Indian Core Setup - Stage 2



KID FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

Black is castled and ready to challenge White's center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, castle, then strike with ...e5 or ...c5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to stabilize the center and use the extra space to restrict Black.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2

MEMORY RULE

The shell is preparation; the central break is the opening's real point.

02. Decision Framework

King's Indian Core Setup - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Choose ...e5 for direct central contact or ...c5 to attack d4 from the flank.
PIECE JOB	The g7-bishop and f6-knight pressure the center before it opens.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not drift after castling; an unchallenged center will become a lasting space advantage.
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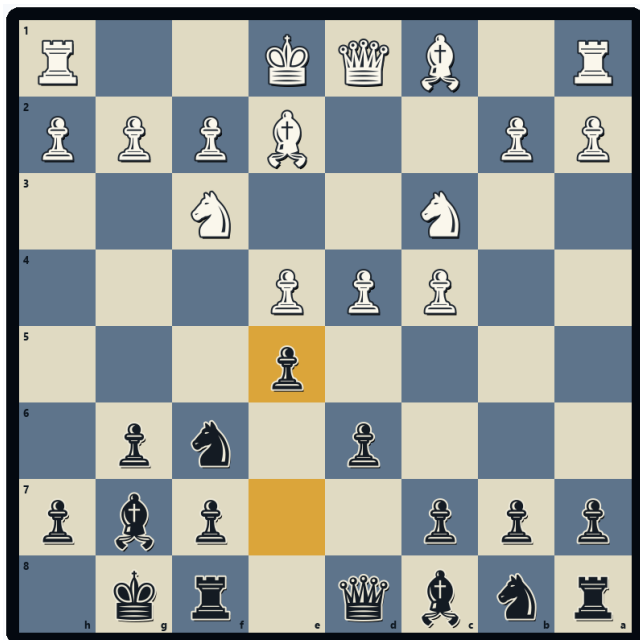
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The shell is preparation; the central break is the opening's real point.

03. Classical King's Indian with ...e5 - Stage 1



KID CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

Black has challenged d4 with ...e5 before White can consolidate.

PRIMARY PLAN

If the center closes, prepare kingside play while keeping an eye on White's queenside race.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White usually seeks d5, c5, and b4 to gain queenside space.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5

MEMORY RULE

Closed center: White goes queenside; Black prepares kingside counterplay.

03. Decision Framework

Classical King's Indian with ...e5 - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	After d5, ...f5 becomes the thematic break once the f6-knight moves and pieces are ready.
PIECE JOB	The c6-knight often belongs on e7, where it supports ...f5 and clears the c-pawn.
TACTICAL WARNING	Never play ...f5 while the f6-knight blocks the pawn or the center can open against your king.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attacking pieces unless an exchange removes a key defender or slows White's queenside play.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate deeply only when the center may change or either wing has a forcing breakthrough.

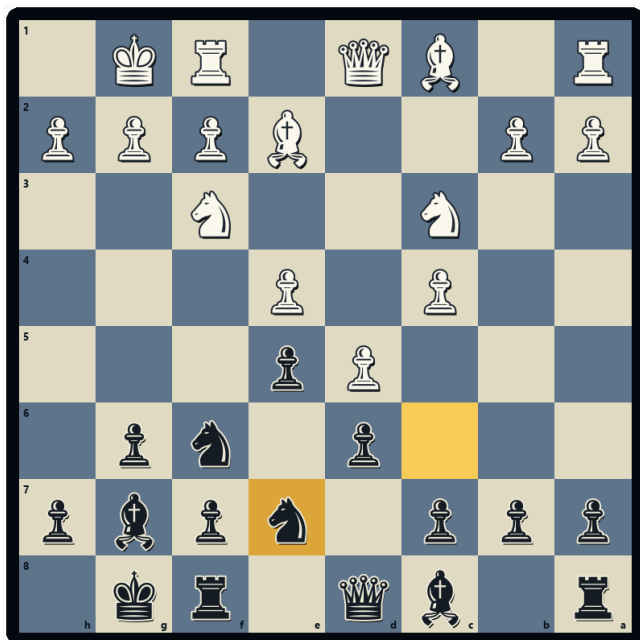
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center: White goes queenside; Black prepares kingside counterplay.

04. Classical King's Indian with ...e5 - Stage 2



KID CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

White has closed the center and Black has rerouted the c6-knight.

PRIMARY PLAN

If the center closes, prepare kingside play while keeping an eye on White's queenside race.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White usually seeks d5, c5, and b4 to gain queenside space.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

MEMORY RULE

Closed center: White goes queenside; Black prepares kingside counterplay.

04. Decision Framework

Classical King's Indian with ...e5 - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	After d5, ...f5 becomes the thematic break once the f6-knight moves and pieces are ready.
PIECE JOB	The c6-knight often belongs on e7, where it supports ...f5 and clears the c-pawn.
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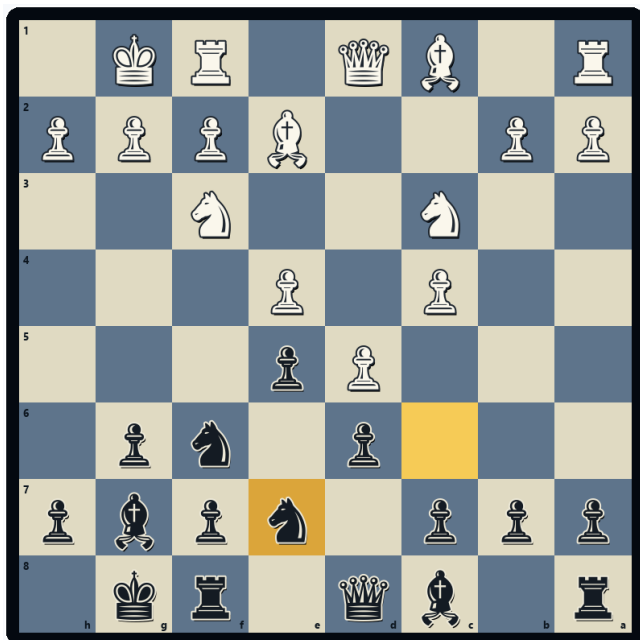
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NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center: White goes queenside; Black prepares kingside counterplay.

05. Closed-Center Knight Route - Stage 1



KID CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

Black must reorganize before beginning the kingside operation.

PRIMARY PLAN

Reposition the knights, play ...f5, and add pieces before advancing more pawns.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White will use the same time for c5, b4, and pressure on d6.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

MEMORY RULE

Every maneuver must name the pawn break or square it is preparing.

05. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Knight Route - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 is justified after the f6-knight moves and the king is castled.
PIECE JOB	The knights travel toward d7, e7, f6, or g6 according to which squares support the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	A memorized knight tour can fail when White changes the center or creates a direct queenside threat.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange a knight only if the remaining pieces still control the break squares and attacking entry points.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Do not calculate every knight route; compare two routes by the break each one supports.

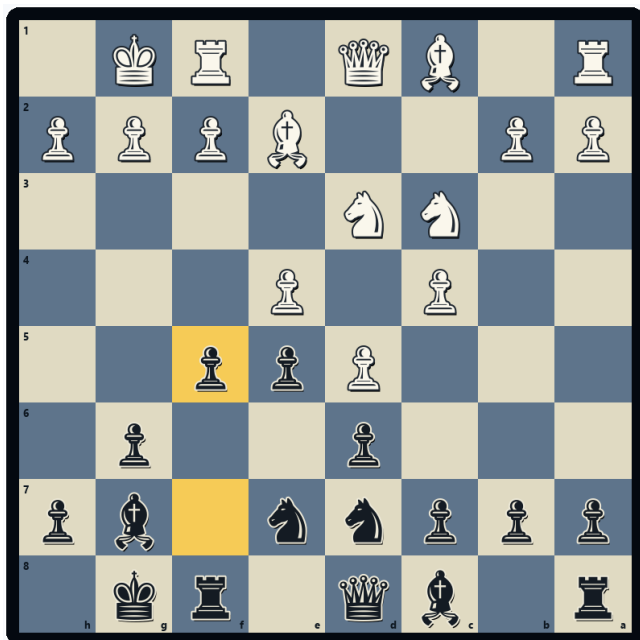
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Every maneuver must name the pawn break or square it is preparing.

06. Closed-Center Knight Route - Stage 2



KID CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

The knight route has cleared f6 and Black has achieved ...f5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Reposition the knights, play ...f5, and add pieces before advancing more pawns.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White will use the same time for c5, b4, and pressure on d6.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5

MEMORY RULE

Every maneuver must name the pawn break or square it is preparing.

06. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Knight Route - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 is justified after the f6-knight moves and the king is castled.
PIECE JOB	The knights travel toward d7, e7, f6, or g6 according to which squares support the attack.
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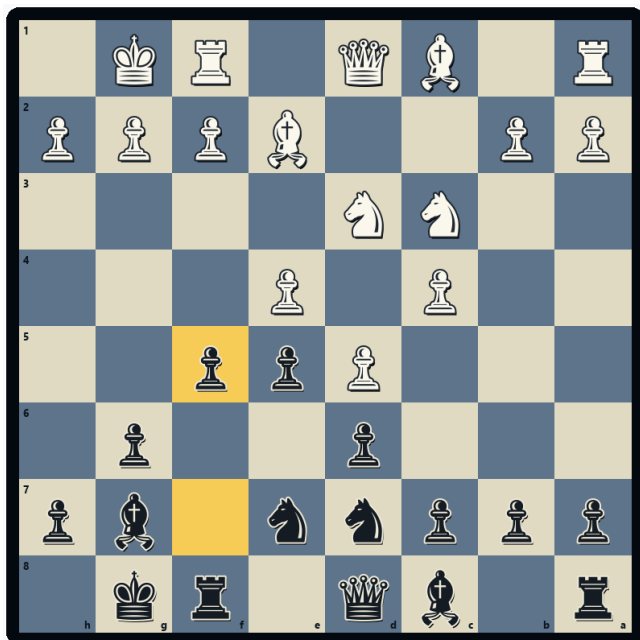
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NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Every maneuver must name the pawn break or square it is preparing.

07. Mar del Plata Kingside Break - Stage 1



KID ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

Black has begun the thematic kingside break in a closed center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the f-file, g-file, and kingside space with pieces rather than pushing pawns alone.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White races on the queenside and may sacrifice time there to slow Black's attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5

MEMORY RULE

A pawn storm is justified by supporting pieces and forcing threats, not appearance.

07. Decision Framework

Mar del Plata Kingside Break - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 creates contact; the correct recapture depends on which file and diagonal Black can use.
PIECE JOB	The queen, rook, dark bishop, and knights must join before Black claims a real attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	The opened g-file helps only if Black controls tactical checks against the loosened king.
TRADE FILTER	Trade White's key defenders, but avoid exchanging all attacking pieces into a weak-pawn ending.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time when a capture changes king safety; otherwise improve the next attacking piece quickly.

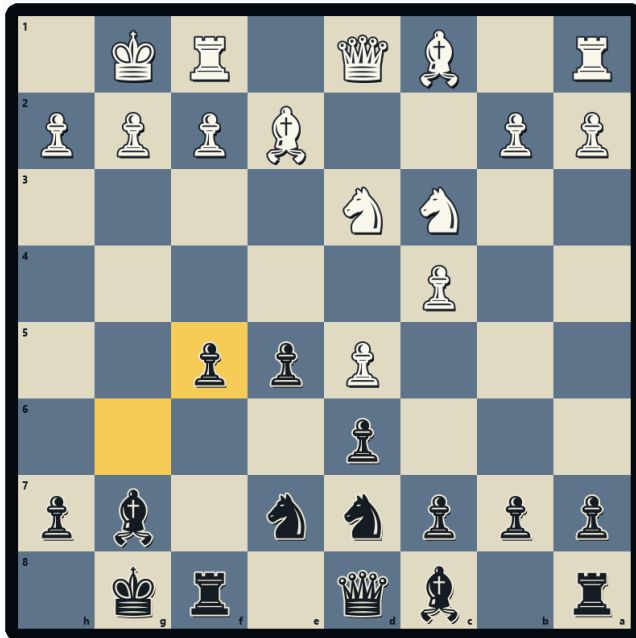
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A pawn storm is justified by supporting pieces and forcing threats, not appearance.

08. Mar del Plata Kingside Break - Stage 2



KID ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

The g-pawn recapture has opened lines while weakening Black's king cover.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the f-file, g-file, and kingside space with pieces rather than pushing pawns alone.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White races on the queenside and may sacrifice time there to slow Black's attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. exf5 gxf5

MEMORY RULE

A pawn storm is justified by supporting pieces and forcing threats, not appearance.

08. Decision Framework

Mar del Plata Kingside Break - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 creates contact; the correct recapture depends on which file and diagonal Black can use.
PIECE JOB	The queen, rook, dark bishop, and knights must join before Black claims a real attack.
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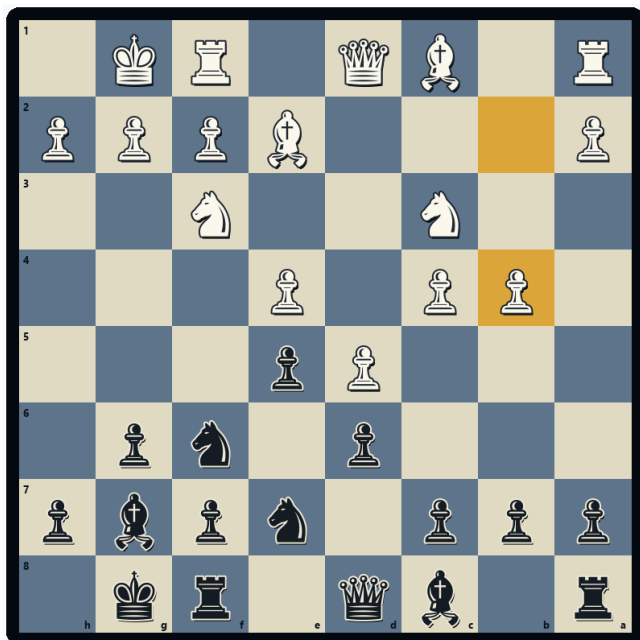
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A pawn storm is justified by supporting pieces and forcing threats, not appearance.

09. Bayonet Attack Race - Stage 1



KID CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

White has announced fast queenside expansion with b4.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare ...f5 efficiently and defend only concrete queenside threats.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants c5, pressure on d6, and open files before Black reaches the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4

MEMORY RULE

In a race, compare checks and breakthroughs-not the amount of territory each side owns.

09. Decision Framework

Bayonet Attack Race - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 is Black's counterweight; delays must be justified by an immediate defensive need.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight often leaves for d7 so the f-pawn can advance without losing coordination.
TACTICAL WARNING	Queenside material can fall while Black attacks, but calculate whether White's breakthrough includes checks.
TRADE FILTER	Trade queens only if the queenside damage is manageable; attacking chances often depend on keeping queens.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count moves to forcing threats on both wings rather than calculating unrelated side variations.

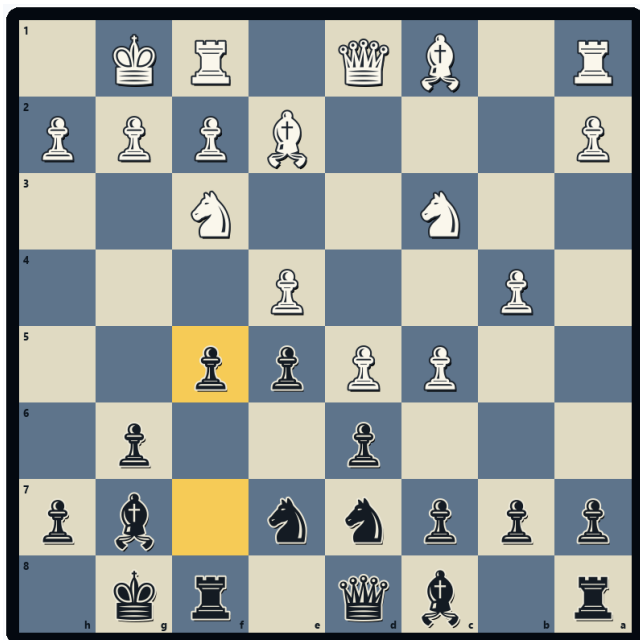
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In a race, compare checks and breakthroughs-not the amount of territory each side owns.

10. Bayonet Attack Race - Stage 2



KID CLASSICAL

READ THE POSITION

Both sides have made contact on their chosen wings.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare ...f5 efficiently and defend only concrete queenside threats.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants c5, pressure on d6, and open files before Black reaches the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nd7 10. c5 f5

MEMORY RULE

In a race, compare checks and breakthroughs-not the amount of territory each side owns.

10. Decision Framework

Bayonet Attack Race - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 is Black's counterweight; delays must be justified by an immediate defensive need.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight often leaves for d7 so the f-pawn can advance without losing coordination.
TACTICAL WARNING	Queenside material can fall while Black attacks, but calculate whether White's breakthrough includes checks.
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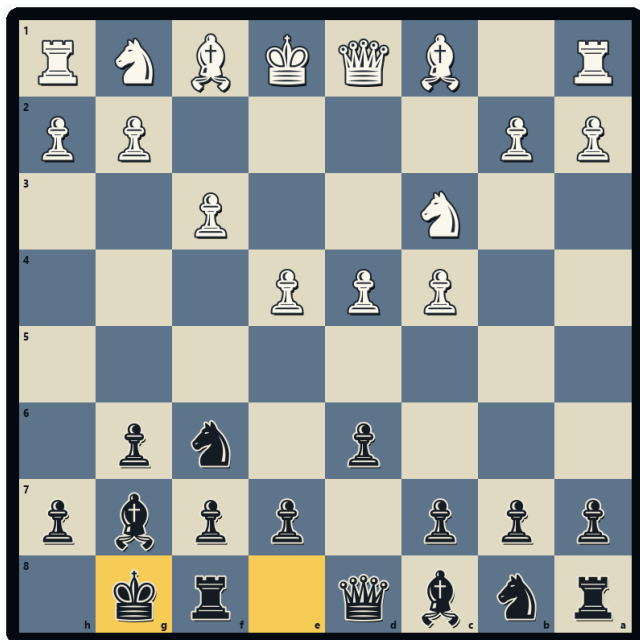
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In a race, compare checks and breakthroughs-not the amount of territory each side owns.

11. Sämisch Center - Stage 1



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has reinforced e4 with f3 before normal kingside development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Create prompt central or queenside counterplay before White completes Be3, Qd2, and expansion.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may castle long, play g4, or maintain the broad center with strong piece support.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against f3, challenge the center before White's extra support becomes an attack.

11. Decision Framework

Sämisch Center - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use ...e5, ...c5, or ...c6 according to the move order; a slow automatic ...f5 plan may be late.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop and queenside knight need useful roles before White's attack accelerates.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch sacrifices on the kingside and tactical pressure along the h-file after White advances pawns.
TRADE FILTER	A queen trade can be welcome when it removes White's attack without leaving a hopeless space disadvantage.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	When White's setup is aggressive but no tactic exists yet, spend time on the central break.

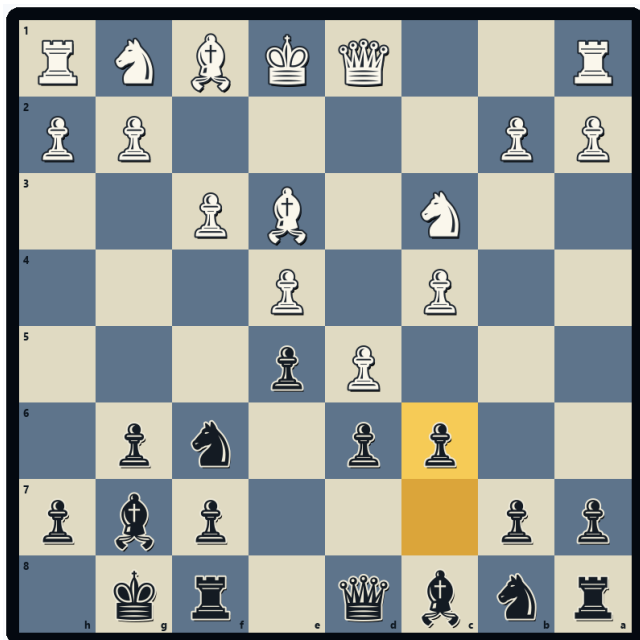
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against f3, challenge the center before White's extra support becomes an attack.

12. Sämisch Center - Stage 2



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black is attacking the Sämisch center with ...c6 after it closes.

PRIMARY PLAN

Create prompt central or queenside counterplay before White completes Be3, Qd2, and expansion.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may castle long, play g4, or maintain the broad center with strong piece support.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 c6

MEMORY RULE

Against f3, challenge the center before White's extra support becomes an attack.

12. Decision Framework

Sämisch Center - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use ...e5, ...c5, or ...c6 according to the move order; a slow automatic ...f5 plan may be late.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop and queenside knight need useful roles before White's attack accelerates.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch sacrifices on the kingside and tactical pressure along the h-file after White advances pawns.
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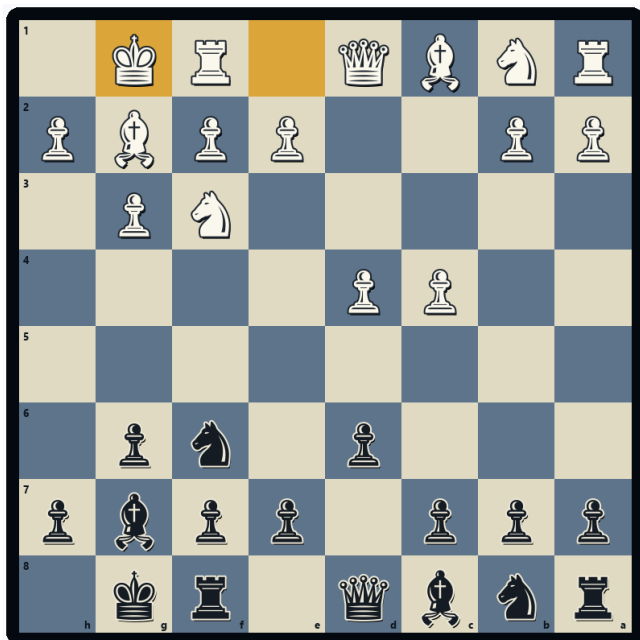
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NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against f3, challenge the center before White's extra support becomes an attack.

13. Fianchetto King's Indian - Stage 1



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has matched Black's fianchetto and built excellent king safety.

PRIMARY PLAN

Seek central or queenside play and improve pieces before committing the f-pawn.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants stable pressure, central expansion, and control of the long diagonal.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against White's fianchetto, win the center before trying to win the king.

13. Decision Framework

Fianchetto King's Indian - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 or ...e5 should challenge d4; choose the break that activates more Black pieces.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop and queenside knight often determine whether Black's position becomes active.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch a fake mating attack against a well-defended king while White controls the center.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange bishops only when the resulting dark squares or central files favor Black's remaining pieces.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use strategic speed until central contact appears; calculate longer when pawn exchanges open diagonals.

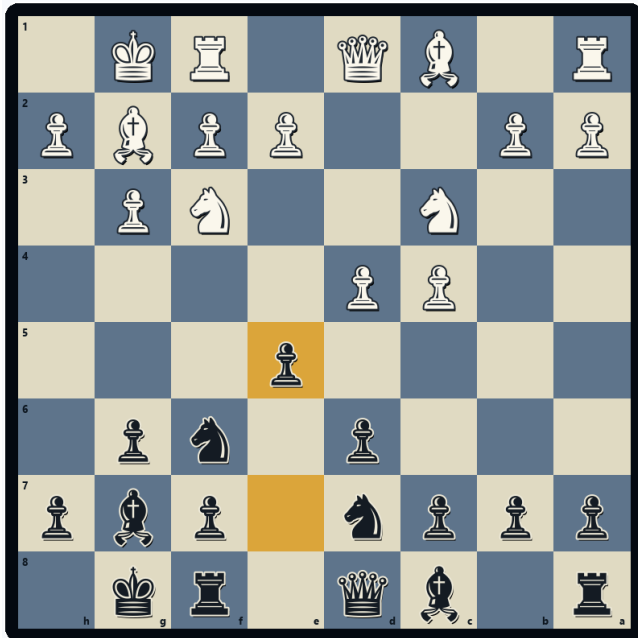
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against White's fianchetto, win the center before trying to win the king.

14. Fianchetto King's Indian - Stage 2



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black has challenged the center while both kings are securely developed.

PRIMARY PLAN

Seek central or queenside play and improve pieces before committing the f-pawn.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants stable pressure, central expansion, and control of the long diagonal.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5

MEMORY RULE

Against White's fianchetto, win the center before trying to win the king.

14. Decision Framework

Fianchetto King's Indian - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 or ...e5 should challenge d4; choose the break that activates more Black pieces.
PIECE JOB	The c8-bishop and queenside knight often determine whether Black's position becomes active.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch a fake mating attack against a well-defended king while White controls the center.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange bishops only when the resulting dark squares or central files favor Black's remaining pieces.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use strategic speed until central contact appears; calculate longer when pawn exchanges open diagonals.

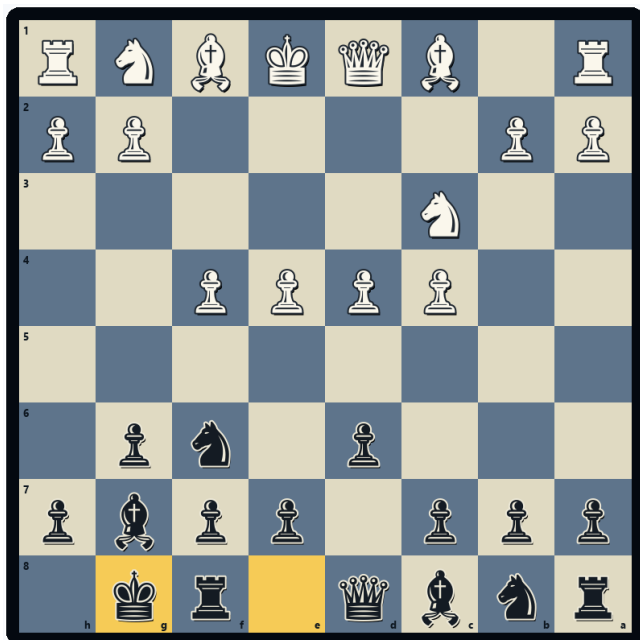
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against White's fianchetto, win the center before trying to win the king.

15. Four Pawns Attack - Stage 1



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has claimed maximum central space before completing development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open lines against the center while White's king and queenside pieces are undeveloped.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5 or d5, then rapid development behind the space advantage.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Maximum space is a target when the pieces supporting it are still at home.

15. Decision Framework

Four Pawns Attack - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 and ...e6 attack the base of the chain; ...e5 is another direct option in suitable lines.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight and g7-bishop become stronger when central files and diagonals open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not chase the pawn front with wing moves while White can advance with tempo in the center.
TRADE FILTER	Central pawn trades usually help Black when they expose White's development lag without losing activity.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate the forcing central sequence, not every possible white kingside pawn move.

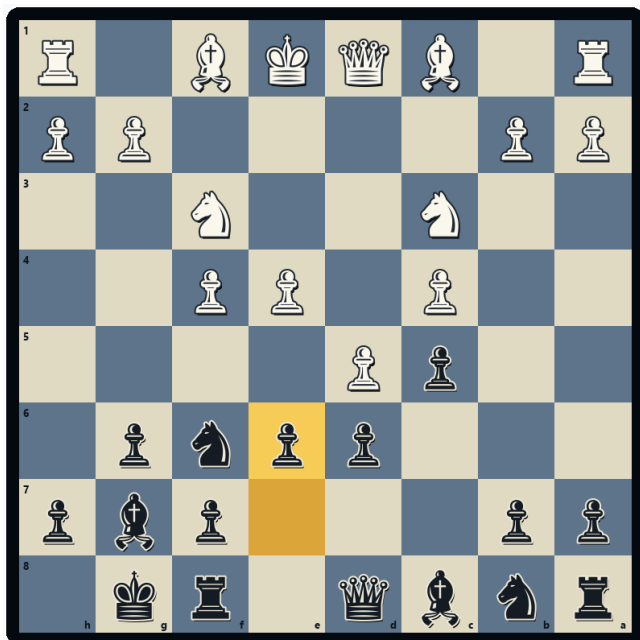
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Maximum space is a target when the pieces supporting it are still at home.

16. Four Pawns Attack - Stage 2



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black has attacked the advanced pawn chain with ...c5 and ...e6.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open lines against the center while White's king and queenside pieces are undeveloped.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5 or d5, then rapid development behind the space advantage.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Nf3 c5 7. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

Maximum space is a target when the pieces supporting it are still at home.

16. Decision Framework

Four Pawns Attack - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 and ...e6 attack the base of the chain; ...e5 is another direct option in suitable lines.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight and g7-bishop become stronger when central files and diagonals open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not chase the pawn front with wing moves while White can advance with tempo in the center.
TRADE FILTER	Central pawn trades usually help Black when they expose White's development lag without losing activity.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate the forcing central sequence, not every possible white kingside pawn move.

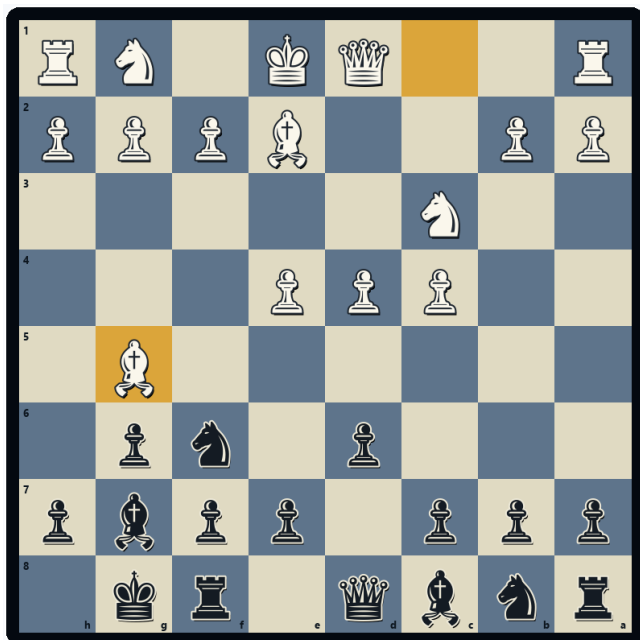
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Maximum space is a target when the pieces supporting it are still at home.

17. Averbakh System - Stage 1



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has developed Bg5 to restrain Black's normal kingside play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center with ...c5 or ...e5 and avoid giving White a comfortable bind.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to restrict ...f5 and maintain space without exposing the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5

MEMORY RULE

When White restrains the wing, Black should challenge the center.

17. Decision Framework

Averbakh System - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 followed by ...e6 attacks the advanced center from its base.
PIECE JOB	The queen's knight and c8-bishop must support central activity rather than remain boxed in.
TACTICAL WARNING	Check tactical pins before moving the queen or f-pawn while White's bishop controls important lines.
TRADE FILTER	Trading the g5-bishop is useful only if Black gains central freedom or removes a real restraint.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time when a pin changes the legality of a central capture; otherwise follow the central plan.

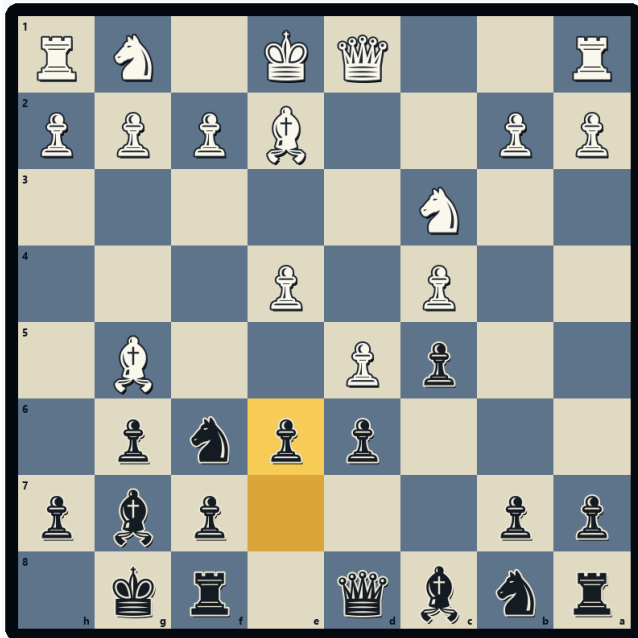
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When White restrains the wing, Black should challenge the center.

18. Averbakh System - Stage 2



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black has answered restraint with central pressure against d5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center with ...c5 or ...e5 and avoid giving White a comfortable bind.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to restrict ...f5 and maintain space without exposing the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

When White restrains the wing, Black should challenge the center.

18. Decision Framework

Averbakh System - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 followed by ...e6 attacks the advanced center from its base.
PIECE JOB	The queen's knight and c8-bishop must support central activity rather than remain boxed in.
TACTICAL WARNING	Check tactical pins before moving the queen or f-pawn while White's bishop controls important lines.
TRADE FILTER	Trading the g5-bishop is useful only if Black gains central freedom or removes a real restraint.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time when a pin changes the legality of a central capture; otherwise follow the central plan.

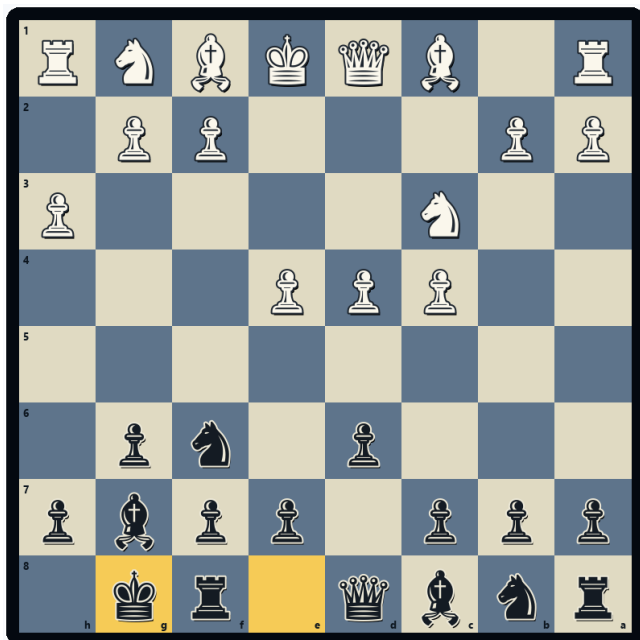
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When White restrains the wing, Black should challenge the center.

19. Makogonov h3 System - Stage 1



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White has used h3 to restrict ...Ng4 and support a controlled buildup.

PRIMARY PLAN

Define the center, claim useful wing space, and avoid forcing an attack that White has restrained.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants Be3, g4 in some lines, and flexible development with fewer tactical concessions.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against h3, build counterplay patiently but do not surrender the center.

19. Decision Framework

Makogonov h3 System - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 defines the structure; ...c5 remains an alternative when central pressure is preferable.
PIECE JOB	The queenside knight and a-pawn can restrain White's expansion while kingside pieces reorganize.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not assume h3 is a wasted tempo; it removes tactical ideas and can support a later pawn storm.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when it improves Black's space or removes a piece central to White's restraint.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use the extra time to compare ...e5 and ...c5 rather than calculating a nonexistent attack.

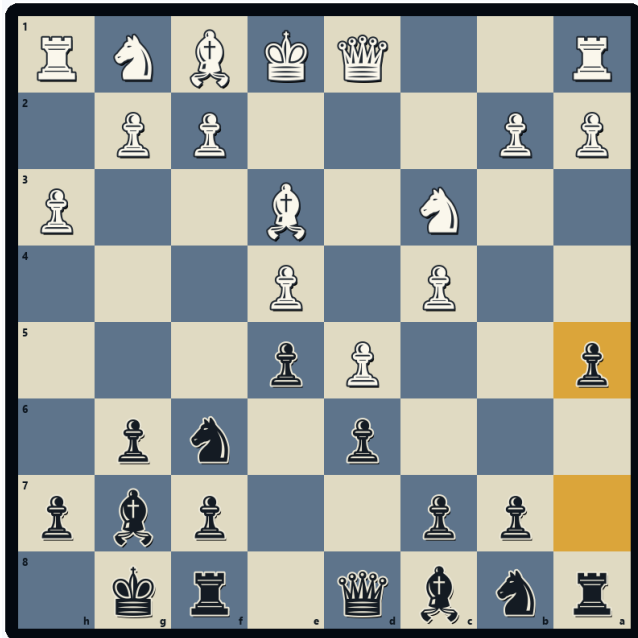
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against h3, build counterplay patiently but do not surrender the center.

20. Makogonov h3 System - Stage 2



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

The center is closed and Black has gained queenside space with ...a5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Define the center, claim useful wing space, and avoid forcing an attack that White has restrained.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants Be3, g4 in some lines, and flexible development with fewer tactical concessions.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 a5

MEMORY RULE

Against h3, build counterplay patiently but do not surrender the center.

20. Decision Framework

Makogonov h3 System - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...e5 defines the structure; ...c5 remains an alternative when central pressure is preferable.
PIECE JOB	The queenside knight and a-pawn can restrain White's expansion while kingside pieces reorganize.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not assume h3 is a wasted tempo; it removes tactical ideas and can support a later pawn storm.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when it improves Black's space or removes a piece central to White's restraint.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use the extra time to compare ...e5 and ...c5 rather than calculating a nonexistent attack.

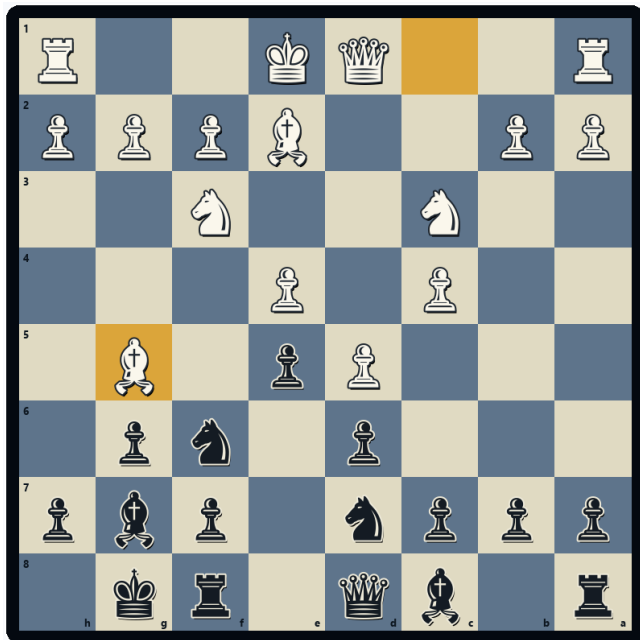
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against h3, build counterplay patiently but do not surrender the center.

21. Petrosian Restraint - Stage 1



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White's Bg5 restrains Black before committing to a wing race.

PRIMARY PLAN

Question the restraining bishop, reorganize pieces, and choose the attacking break with care.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants time for queenside expansion while Black's kingside pieces remain awkward.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 Nbd7 8. Bg5

MEMORY RULE

Restraint is answered by purposeful preparation, not by a frustrated pawn rush.

21. Decision Framework

Petrosian Restraint - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 remains thematic, but preparatory ...h6 and ...g5 must not become weaknesses without a follow-up.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight and dark bishop need open routes before Black commits more kingside pawns.
TACTICAL WARNING	Kingside pawn advances can trap a bishop or weaken Black's king; calculate both outcomes.
TRADE FILTER	Trading the restraining bishop may free Black, but giving up the fianchetto bishop can damage king safety.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer when chasing a bishop changes the pawn shield; otherwise improve coordination.

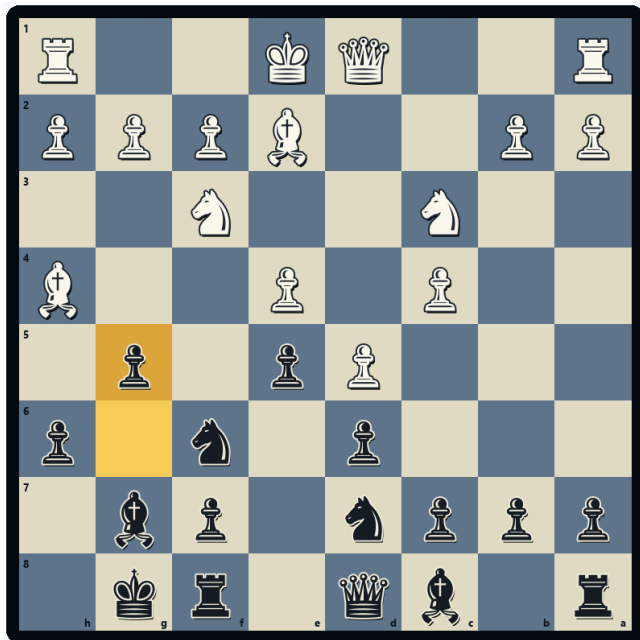
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Restraint is answered by purposeful preparation, not by a frustrated pawn rush.

22. Petrosian Restraint - Stage 2



KID WHITE SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black has challenged the restraining bishop with kingside space.

PRIMARY PLAN

Question the restraining bishop, reorganize pieces, and choose the attacking break with care.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants time for queenside expansion while Black's kingside pieces remain awkward.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 Nbd7 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 g5

MEMORY RULE

Restraint is answered by purposeful preparation, not by a frustrated pawn rush.

22. Decision Framework

Petrosian Restraint - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...f5 remains thematic, but preparatory ...h6 and ...g5 must not become weaknesses without a follow-up.
PIECE JOB	The f6-knight and dark bishop need open routes before Black commits more kingside pawns.
TACTICAL WARNING	Kingside pawn advances can trap a bishop or weaken Black's king; calculate both outcomes.
TRADE FILTER	Trading the restraining bishop may free Black, but giving up the fianchetto bishop can damage king safety.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer when chasing a bishop changes the pawn shield; otherwise improve coordination.

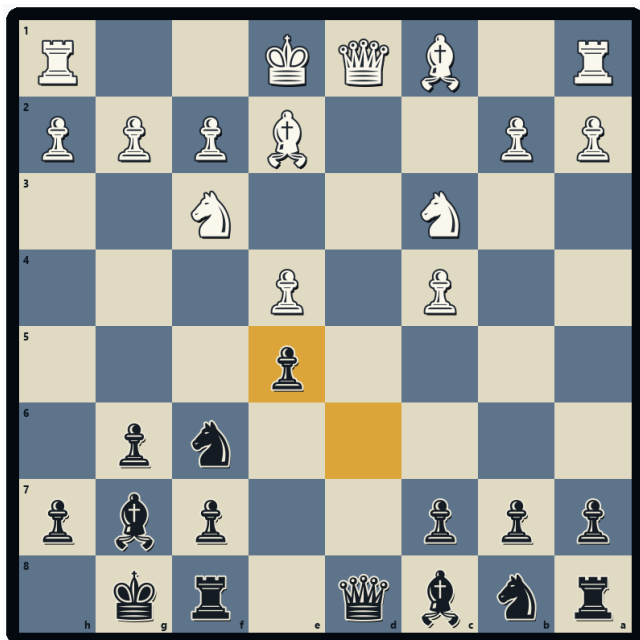
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Restraint is answered by purposeful preparation, not by a frustrated pawn rush.

23. King's Indian Exchange Variation - Stage 1



KID STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

White has exchanged central tension and reduced the usual wing race.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop the queenside, occupy central files, and prevent White from fixing a lasting weakness.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a small space or endgame edge without facing Black's normal attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5

MEMORY RULE

When White exchanges the center, switch from attack mode to activity mode.

23. Decision Framework

King's Indian Exchange Variation - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Pawn breaks are now used to activate pieces and contest files, not to manufacture a kingside storm.
PIECE JOB	Rooks and the c8-bishop become urgent pieces once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play attacking-pattern moves from a closed King's Indian in this simplified center.
TRADE FILTER	Welcome exchanges that complete development, but retain enough activity to avoid a passive ending.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use normal endgame speed unless a central tactic or pawn break changes the structure.

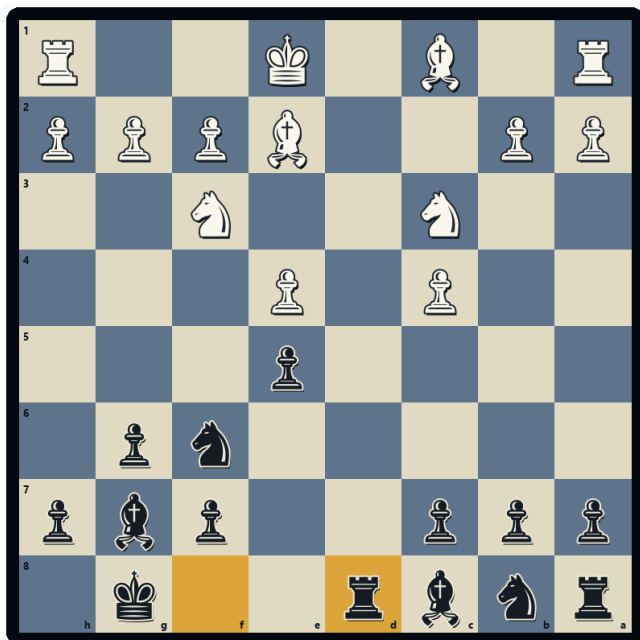
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When White exchanges the center, switch from attack mode to activity mode.

24. King's Indian Exchange Variation - Stage 2



KID STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

The queens are off and Black must play an active, sound endgame.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop the queenside, occupy central files, and prevent White from fixing a lasting weakness.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a small space or endgame edge without facing Black's normal attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8

MEMORY RULE

When White exchanges the center, switch from attack mode to activity mode.

24. Decision Framework

King's Indian Exchange Variation - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Pawn breaks are now used to activate pieces and contest files, not to manufacture a kingside storm.
PIECE JOB	Rooks and the c8-bishop become urgent pieces once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play attacking-pattern moves from a closed King's Indian in this simplified center.
TRADE FILTER	Welcome exchanges that complete development, but retain enough activity to avoid a passive ending.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use normal endgame speed unless a central tactic or pawn break changes the structure.

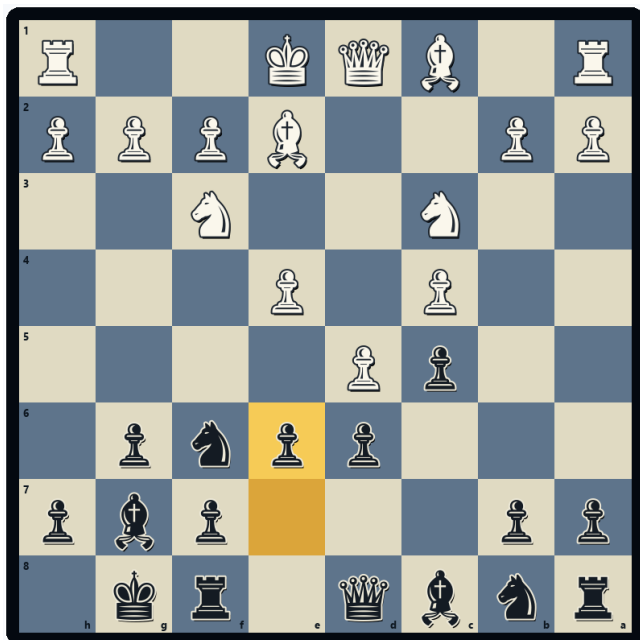
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When White exchanges the center, switch from attack mode to activity mode.

25. King's Indian with ...c5 - Stage 1



KID STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

Black has chosen a Benoni-style attack against d4 and d5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use pressure on d5, active diagonals, and queenside play to compensate for White's space.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to use the d5 pawn as a space wedge and restrict Black's queenside pieces.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

The ...c5 King's Indian attacks the base of the chain, not the king by default.

25. Decision Framework

King's Indian with ...c5 - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 and ...e6 work as a pair: first fix d5, then challenge it.
PIECE JOB	The g7-bishop, queen's knight, and rooks need open files created by central exchanges.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch e5 breaks and tactics on the long diagonal whenever the d4 pawn moves or exchanges.
TRADE FILTER	Trade pieces when it weakens d5 or improves a blockade; avoid exchanges that leave only White's space advantage.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the central capture sequence because each recapture creates a different structure.

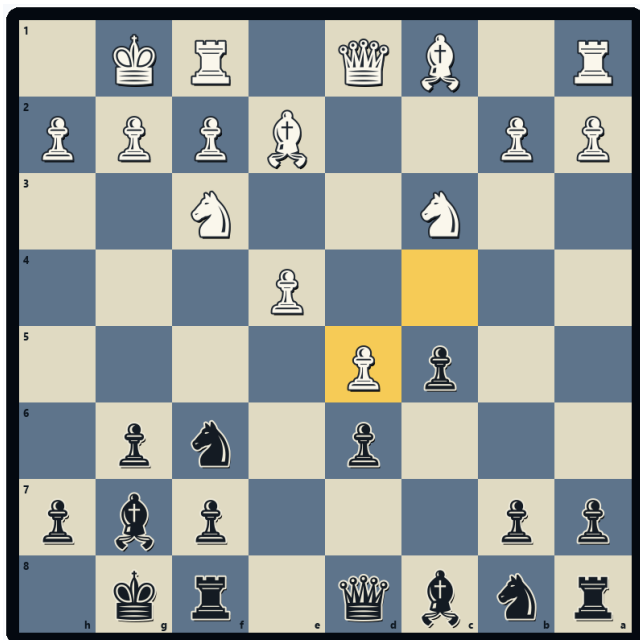
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The ...c5 King's Indian attacks the base of the chain, not the king by default.

26. King's Indian with ...c5 - Stage 2



KID STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

Central exchanges have produced open lines and a white pawn on d5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use pressure on d5, active diagonals, and queenside play to compensate for White's space.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to use the d5 pawn as a space wedge and restrict Black's queenside pieces.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5

MEMORY RULE

The ...c5 King's Indian attacks the base of the chain, not the king by default.

26. Decision Framework

King's Indian with ...c5 - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 and ...e6 work as a pair: first fix d5, then challenge it.
PIECE JOB	The g7-bishop, queen's knight, and rooks need open files created by central exchanges.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch e5 breaks and tactics on the long diagonal whenever the d4 pawn moves or exchanges.
TRADE FILTER	Trade pieces when it weakens d5 or improves a blockade; avoid exchanges that leave only White's space advantage.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the central capture sequence because each recapture creates a different structure.

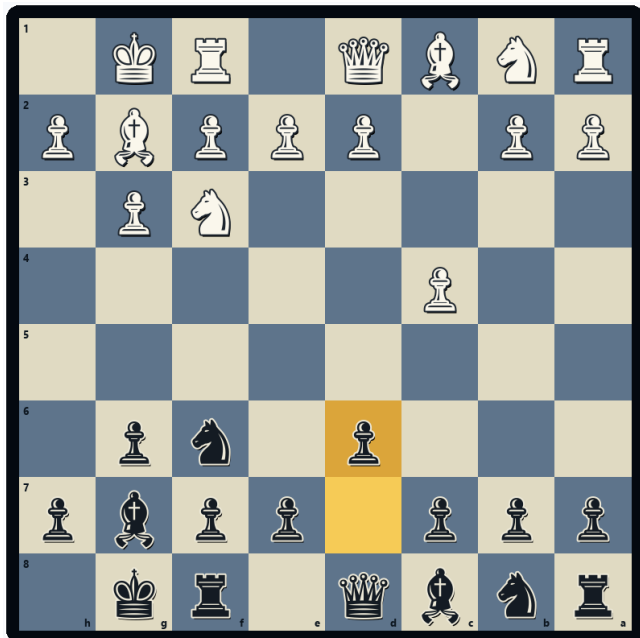
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The ...c5 King's Indian attacks the base of the chain, not the king by default.

27. English and Réti Move Orders - Stage 1



KID MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

White has delayed d4 and e4, so Black must preserve move-order flexibility.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the familiar shell while waiting to see whether ...e5 or ...c5 best meets White's center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to avoid forcing theory and choose the central structure on favorable terms.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. g3 Bg7 4. Bg2 O-O 5. O-O d6

MEMORY RULE

Against flexible move orders, keep Black's breaks flexible too.

27. Decision Framework

English and Réti Move Orders - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Do not commit the c- or e-pawn until White's setup reveals which break gains useful contact.
PIECE JOB	The queen's knight can use d7 or c6 depending on the chosen central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Autopilot can transpose into a poor version if Black blocks the wrong pawn or bishop too early.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve flexible pieces until the center is known; exchange only for a concrete structural gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick pattern recognition early, then pause when White finally commits a central pawn.

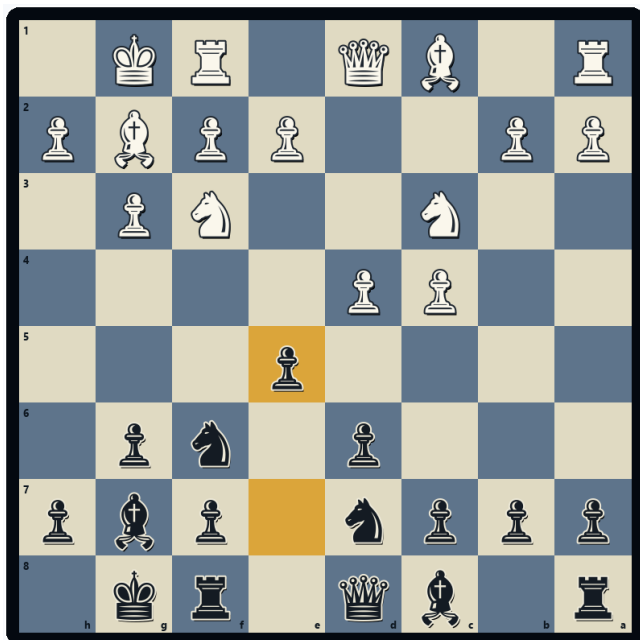
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against flexible move orders, keep Black's breaks flexible too.

28. English and Réti Move Orders - Stage 2



KID MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

The game has transposed toward a King's Indian with both sides developed.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the familiar shell while waiting to see whether ...e5 or ...c5 best meets White's center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to avoid forcing theory and choose the central structure on favorable terms.

REFERENCE LINE

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. g3 Bg7 4. Bg2 O-O 5. O-O d6 6. d4 Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5

MEMORY RULE

Against flexible move orders, keep Black's breaks flexible too.

28. Decision Framework

English and Réti Move Orders - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Do not commit the c- or e-pawn until White's setup reveals which break gains useful contact.
PIECE JOB	The queen's knight can use d7 or c6 depending on the chosen central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Autopilot can transpose into a poor version if Black blocks the wrong pawn or bishop too early.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve flexible pieces until the center is known; exchange only for a concrete structural gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick pattern recognition early, then pause when White finally commits a central pawn.

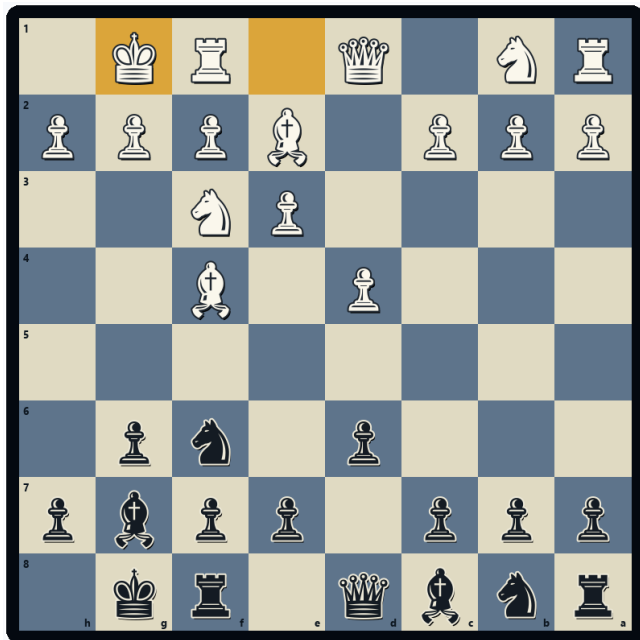
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against flexible move orders, keep Black's breaks flexible too.

29. London and Trompowsky Detours - Stage 1



KID MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

White has chosen a London structure instead of a broad c4-e4 center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge d4 promptly, develop naturally, and adapt the shell rather than forcing it.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a reliable development scheme and may attack before committing the c-pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O

MEMORY RULE

A repertoire is a framework: when White changes the center, Black changes the plan.

29. Decision Framework

London and Trompowsky Detours - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 is often more direct against the London; against Bg5, challenge the bishop and center concretely.
PIECE JOB	The queen's bishop and c-pawn need active roles because White has declined the main center.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not waste tempi reaching a King's Indian diagram that White's move order has made irrelevant.
TRADE FILTER	Trade an early bishop only when it improves Black's center or damages White's structure without losing time.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at White's early bishop move; it is a move-order decision, not a calculation marathon.

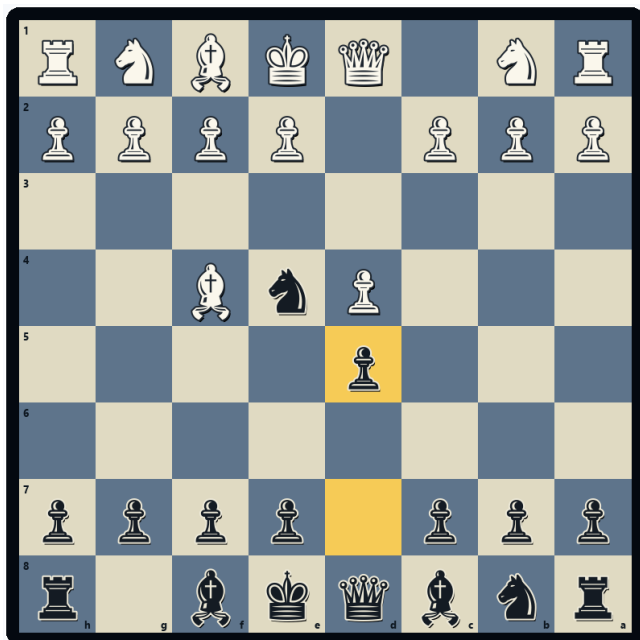
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A repertoire is a framework: when White changes the center, Black changes the plan.

30. London and Trompowsky Detours - Stage 2



KID MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

The early Trompowsky bishop has changed Black's normal development route.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge d4 promptly, develop naturally, and adapt the shell rather than forcing it.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a reliable development scheme and may attack before committing the c-pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bf4 d5

MEMORY RULE

A repertoire is a framework: when White changes the center, Black changes the plan.

30. Decision Framework

London and Trompowsky Detours - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	...c5 is often more direct against the London; against Bg5, challenge the bishop and center concretely.
PIECE JOB	The queen's bishop and c-pawn need active roles because White has declined the main center.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not waste tempi reaching a King's Indian diagram that White's move order has made irrelevant.
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ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A repertoire is a framework: when White changes the center, Black changes the plan.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.